

Nicole Siegal

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Professional Experience

Indiana University

2024–Present Postdoctoral Research Fellow, O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs and Department of Pediatrics, IU School of Medicine

University of Hawai'i at Mānoa

2021–2024 Research Assistant, Pacific Alliance Against COVID-19 and Maui Wildfire Exposure Study, UH Economic Research Organization, Department of Economics

2020–2021 Research Assistant, State Epidemiologic Outcomes Workgroup, Pacific Health Analytics Collaborative, Department of Social Work and Public Health

Education

2024 Ph.D., Economics, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa

2020 M.A., Economics, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa

2018 B.A., Economics and Political Science, *cum laude*, Colorado State University

Academic Affiliations

2025–Present Research Affiliate, Jimmy & Rosalynn Carter School of Public Policy, Georgia Institute of Technology

2024–Present Early Career Scholar, Irsay Institute, Indiana University

2025–2026 Leadership Education in Adolescent Health (LEAH) Trainee, Department of Pediatrics, Indiana University School of Medicine

Research

ORCID ID: [0000-0003-3220-1993](https://orcid.org/0000-0003-3220-1993)

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. **Siegal, N.** (2026). The Opioid Epidemic and Presidential Elections. *American Journal of Health Economics*. DOI: [10.1086/742007](https://doi.org/10.1086/742007) (Working Paper Version: [10.2139/ssrn.4808858](https://ssrn.com/abstract=4808858))
2. Gupta, S., Schwartz, K., Bell, L., **Siegal, N.**, & Aalsma, M.C. (2026). Trends in Access to Medications for Opioid Use Disorder (MOUD) among Adolescents with Opioid Use Disorders. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence Reports*, 16, 100417. DOI: [10.1016/j.dadr.2026.100417](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dadr.2026.100417)
3. **Siegal, N.**, Gupta, S., Miles, J., Samples, H., Simon, K., Aalsma, M. C., & Crystal, S. (2026). Medicaid Expansion and Buprenorphine Dispensing in Early vs Recent Expansion States. *JAMA Network Open*, 9(2), e2559803. DOI: [10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2025.59803](https://doi.org/10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2025.59803)
4. **Siegal, N.** & Soni, A. (2025). The Association Between State Gestational Age Limit Abortion Laws and Severe Maternal Morbidity: United States, 2010-2022. *American Journal of Public Health*, 116(3), 341–344. DOI: [10.2105/AJPH.2025.308291](https://doi.org/10.2105/AJPH.2025.308291)

5. **Siegal, N.**, Simon, K., Freedman, S., Aalsma, M. C., & Wing, C. (2025). Stalled Improvements? Youth Opioid Misuse 2015–2022. *Journal of Adolescent Health*, 77(2). DOI: [10.1016/j.jadohealth.2025.05.008](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jadohealth.2025.05.008)
6. Bonham, C., Juarez, R., & **Siegal, N.** (2023). Long-COVID and Unemployment in Hawaii. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, 20(13), 6231. DOI: [10.3390/ijerph20136231](https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph20136231)
7. Juarez, R., **Siegal, N.**, & Maunakea, A. (2022). The Effects of COVID-19 Vaccine Mandates in Hawaii. *Vaccines*, 10(5), 773. DOI: [10.3390/vaccines10050773](https://doi.org/10.3390/vaccines10050773)

Under Review

8. **Siegal, N.**, Ortega, A., Koumpias, A. M., Wing, C., Simon, K., & Aalsma, M. C. Mental Health Comorbidities in Gambling Disorder and Among Family Members: A Cross-Sectional Analysis of Insurance Claims.
9. **Siegal, N.**, Simon, K., Wing, C., Freedman, S., & Aalsma, M. C. Discrepancies Between Self-Reported Fentanyl Use and Mortality in the United States.
10. Molina, T., **Siegal, N.**, & Choi, J. Migration Responses to State Abortion Policy. IZA Discussion Paper: docs.iza.org/dp18615.pdf
11. Talmor, N., Adkins, S., **Siegal, N.**, & O'Donoghue, A. Trends in Neonatal Abstinence Syndrome and Prenatal Substance Exposure in the United States, 2000-2023.
12. Constantin, J., Gupta, S., **Siegal, N.**, Simon, K., Miles, J., Samples, H., & Crystal, S. Conditional versus Traditional Medicaid Expansion and Access to Buprenorphine for Opioid Use Disorder.

Research in Progress

13. **Siegal, N.**, Ortega, A., & Gupta, S. Regulatory Frictions, Prescribing Behavior, and Unintended Consequences: Evidence from Gabapentin Policies.
14. **Siegal, N.**, Gupta, S., Aalsma, M. C., Crystal, S., Miles, J., Samples, H., Simon, K., & Pacula, R. Do Synthetic Opioid Overdose Deaths In a Community Affect Provider Prescribing of Buprenorphine?
15. **Siegal, N.**, Bradford, A., Tong, J., Ortega, A., Wing, C., Koumpias, A., Simon, K., & Aalsma M. C. Wagering with Your Well Being? Legalization of Online Gambling and Mental Health.
16. O'Donoghue, A., **Siegal, N.**, Talmor, N., & Adkins, S. The Impact of Abortion Restrictions on Neonatal Opioid Withdrawal Syndrome.
17. Choi, J., Dreyer, M., Shone, H., **Siegal, N.**, Simon, K., & Wing, C. Abortion Regulation and Contraception Demand.
18. Lambros, C., **Siegal, N.**, Constantine, J., Miles, J., Samples, H., Nguyen, T., Simon, K., Gupta, S., & Crystal, S. Pharmaceutical Sales Visits Increased Buprenorphine Prescribing But Rarely Reached Underserved Areas

Technical Reports

1. [“Maui Wildfire Exposure Study: Community Health, Wellbeing, and Resilience,”](#) UHERO - MauiWES, May 2024.
2. [“Public Health Report: Initial Findings from the Maui Wildfire Exposure Study,”](#) UHERO - MauiWES, February 2024.
3. [“Shaping Health in Hawaii: The Influences of Poverty, Housing and Food Insecurity,”](#) UHERO-PAAC, July 2023.

4. [“Public Health Report: Vaccination Booster Uptake Lags as COVID Impact Reach Widens,”](#) UHERO-PAAC, January 2023.
5. [“Public Health Report: Health Effects and Views of COVID-19 in Hawai‘i,”](#) UHERO-PAAC, June 2022.
6. [“The Efficacy of Hawaii COVID-19 Business Mandates,”](#) UHERO-PAAC, October 2021.
7. [“Rapid Literature Review on Behavioral Health in Pandemic–Update,”](#) PHAC-SEOW, July 2021.
8. [“Rapid Literature Review on Homelessness and Substance Use,”](#) PHAC-SEOW, June 2021.
9. [“Rapid Literature Review on Underage Drinking, Pregnancy, and FASD,”](#) PHAC-SEOW, December 2020.
10. [“Rapid Literature Review on Behavioral Health in Pandemic,”](#) PHAC-SEOW, November 2020.

Teaching

Instructor of Record

University of Hawai‘i at Mānoa

Summer 2024, Summer 2021	Intermediate Microeconomics
Fall 2023, Fall 2021, Summer 2020	Principles of Microeconomics
Summer 2022	Economics of Human Resources (Labor Economics)

Teaching Assistant

University of Hawai‘i at Mānoa

Spring 2020	Graduate Advanced Macroeconomic Theory II & Intermediate Macroeconomics
Fall 2019	Graduate Advanced Macroeconomic Theory I, Intermediate Microeconomics, & Economic Forecasting
Spring 2019, Fall 2018	Principles of Microeconomics

Colorado State University

Fall 2017	Principles of Microeconomics
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Selected Honors and Awards

2024	Best Dissertation / Graduating Ph.D. - TK Jayaraman and Family Prize, UH Mānoa Economics Department
2024	Best Student Publication - Dr. Henry Mok & Dr. James Mak Scholarship Award, UH Mānoa Economics Department
2023	Career and Leadership Development Grant, American Association of University Women Honolulu
2023	Burnham O. Campbell Scholarship Award, UH Mānoa Economics Department
2023	Graduate Student Organization Travel Award, UH Mānoa
2023	Travel Funds for Professional Development in Research, UH Mānoa College of Social Sciences

Grants

- 01/2026–06/2027 *What Drives Racial Disparities in Newborn Drug Testing and Prenatal Care? Evidence from Surveillance of State Policies on Reporting and Consent*
Co-Investigator (PI: Cydney McGuire), Amount: \$15,000
Funding Agency: Indiana University, Center for Research on Race & Ethnicity in Society (CRRES)
- 06/2026-05/2029 *Legalized Sports Betting: Unpacking the Trade-Offs for Health, Households, and Social Fabric*
Co-Investigator (PI: Coady Wing & Alberto Ortega), Amount: \$197,433
Funding Agency: Arnold Ventures Foundation

Professional Activities

- **Journal Referee:** The Quarterly Journal of Economics, Nature - Scientific Reports, Journal of Health Economics, Healthcare: The Journal of Delivery Science and Innovation, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications.
- **Conference Service:** *Abstract Reviewer:* APPAM 2026; *Panel Organizer:* ASHEcon 2026 (x3), APPAM 2025 (x3), ASHEcon 2025; *Paper Discussant:* WEAI 2026 (x2), ASHEcon 2026 (x2), ASHEcon 2025, SEA 2024, WEAI 2023.
- **Workshop Organizer:** *Workshop in Social Networks and Health*, Department of Economics, University of Hawai‘i at Mānoa, 2023; *SEOW Quarterly Meetings and Seminars*, PHAC, University of Hawai‘i at Mānoa, 2020-2021.

Presentations *scheduled

Conference Panel Presentations

- 2026 “Wagering with Your Well Being? Legalization of Online Gambling and Mental Health.” Western Economic Association International (**WEAI**) Annual Conference, Denver, CO.*
- 2026 “Regulatory Frictions, Prescribing Behavior, and Unintended Consequences: Evidence from Gabapentin Policies.” Western Economic Association International (**WEAI**) Annual Conference, Denver, CO.*
- 2026 “Wagering with Your Well Being? Legalization of Online Gambling and Mental Health.” Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists (**ASHEcon**), Minneapolis, MN.
- 2026 “Do Synthetic Opioid Overdose Deaths In a Community Affect Provider Prescribing of Buprenorphine?” Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists (**ASHEcon**), Minneapolis, MN.
- 2026 “Medicaid Expansion and Buprenorphine Dispensing in Early vs Recent Expansion States.” AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (**ARM**), Seattle, WA.
- 2026 “Do Synthetic Opioid Overdose Deaths In a Community Affect Provider Prescribing of Buprenorphine?” (poster). AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (**ARM**), Seattle, WA.
- 2026 “Regulatory Frictions, Prescribing Behavior, and Unintended Consequences: Evidence from Gabapentin Policies,” (poster). AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting (**ARM**), Seattle, WA.
- 2025 “Wagering with Your Well Being? Legalization of Online Gambling and Mental Health.” Southern Economic Association (**SEA**) Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL.

- 2025 “Abortion Regulation and Contraception Demand.” Southern Economic Association (**SEA**) Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL.
- 2025 “Regulatory Frictions, Prescribing Behavior, and Unintended Consequences: Evidence from Gabapentin Policies.” Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (**APPAM**) Annual Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA.
- 2025 “Association of Medicaid Expansion With Buprenorphine Prescribing in Early vs. Recent Expansion.” Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (**APPAM**) Annual Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA.
- 2025 “Wagering with Your Well Being? Legalization of Online Gambling and Mental Health.” Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (**APPAM**) Annual Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA.
- 2025 “Controlled Substance Designation and Medical Substitution: Evidence from Gabapentin Monitoring and Upscheduling.” Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists (**ASHEcon**), Nashville, TN.
- 2024 “U.S. State Abortion Policies and Interstate Migration.” Southern Economic Association (**SEA**) Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.
- 2023 “Exposure to Deaths-of-Despair and U.S. Presidential Elections.” Western Economic Association International (**WEAI**) Annual Conference, San Diego, CA.

Invited Presentations & Seminars

- 2026 Addictions Practice Group, New Jersey Association of Mental Health and Addiction Agencies (NJAMHAA), virtual.
- 2026 Accounting, Economics, & Finance Department, Tennessee State University (TSU), Nashville, TN.
- 2026 Opioid Policy, Tools, and Information Center (OPTIC) Opioid Policy Pioneers Summit, RAND, Santa Monica, CA.
- 2025 School of Economic Sciences Seminar Series, Washington State University (WSU), Pullman, WA.
- 2025 Third Annual Research Fest, Indiana University School of Medicine (IUSM), Bloomington, IN.
- 2025 Division of Children’s Health Services Research (CHSR) Works in Progress Meeting, Indiana University School of Medicine (IUSM), Indianapolis, IN.
- 2024 Office of Economics and Analysis, U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA), virtual.
- 2024 Hawai‘i Economic Association (HEA) Pau Hana, Honolulu, HI.
- 2023 Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession (CSWEP) Health Mentoring Workshop, virtual.
- 2023 Economics Department Microeconomics Workshop, University of Hawai‘i - Mānoa (UHM), Honolulu, HI.
- 2022 Economics Department Applied Microeconomics Workshop, University of Hawai‘i - Mānoa (UHM), Honolulu, HI.

References

- Sumedha Gupta, Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Indiana University - Indianapolis, (312) 480-9677, sugupta@iu.edu
- Coady Wing, Professor, O'Neill School of Public & Environmental Affairs, Indiana University, (812) 855-0563, cwing@iu.edu
- Matthew C. Aalsma, Professor, Department of Pediatrics, Indiana University School of Medicine, (317) 274-8812, maalsma@iu.edu
- Alberto Ortega, Assistant Professor, O'Neill School of Public & Environmental Affairs, Indiana University, (812) 856-5789, alorte@iu.edu
- Teresa Molina, Associate Professor, Department of Economics, University of Hawai'i - Mānoa, (808) 956-7080, tmolina@hawaii.edu
- Timothy Halliday, Professor, Department of Economics, University of Hawai'i - Mānoa, (808) 956-8615, halliday@hawaii.edu